participated in the national convention that had started in 1993. The convention would continue to meet sporadically until 2007. As the convention approached closure, the KIO submitted a final proposal, which included 19 points. The authorities did not reply to the KIO request and the issue was never discussed during the ending sessions of the convention.

The Kachins took a stand against the referendum to promulgate the new constitution. Kachin leader Dr. Tu Ja resigned from the KIO and formed a new party, the Kachin State Progressive Party, in order to participate in the electoral process. This was done in order to adhere to the government requirement that prohibited parties desist from having contact with organizations in revolt against the state. In spite of this, the Kachin party was denied permission to participate in the elections. The Kachin leadership was disappointed with the government decision—they felt that over a decade of cooperation was meaningless.

Kachin leaders faced heavy criticism for having been denied electoral participation. Many citizens felt that the Kachin leadership was overly concerned with the extraction of resources from the region rather than making significant political gains. The ceasefire agreement gave the military more of an advantage in dealing with the ethnic communities. Local citizens felt that social and economic cooperation had been an utter failure for the common Kachin citizen. The period of the ceasefire agreement saw a significant increase in drug abuse and HIV/AIDS within the Kachin community.

Hostilities between the KIO and government intensified during 2010 to 2011. The government declared the earlier ceasefire void and took several aggressive steps that were regarded as hostile by the Kachins. The Myanmar authorities decided to implement the following: the closure of several KIO offices, the failure to allow Kachin political parties to register for the elections, and altering the tone in communications by referring to the members of the Kachin movement as insurgents.

In early June 2010, the conflict reached an escalation point. Myanmar forces clashed with KIO forces close to the site of two Chinese-operated hydroelectric dams at Tarpein. Several KIO representatives were captured and killed and a Kachin outpost was overrun. This lead to the Kachin forces being put on war alert. Kachin forces destroyed several government